Product Management Intern

Case Study

Prepared by

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August, 2026

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Introduction

This document has been prepared in response to the Intern Product Manager case study assignment provided by Playable Factory. Its purpose is to demonstrate a practical understanding of playable ads, product thinking, and creative problem-solving within the mobile UA (user acquisition) ecosystem.

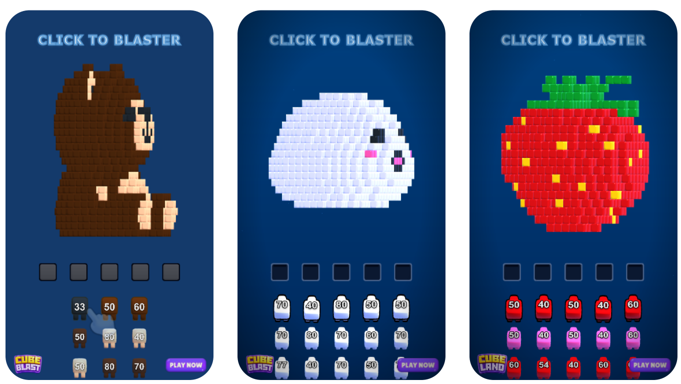
The report is organized into three main tasks. Task 1 identifies a game company that could benefit from Playable Factory's services and proposes a playable ad concept for it. Task 2 presents a product improvement proposal for one of Playable Factory's own products. Task 3 evaluates an existing playable ad built with Playable Studio and outlines the most critical improvements that could be made to it.

Each section reflects my own analysis and creative direction, aiming to show how I would approach product management challenges in a playable-ads and mobile-gaming context.

Task-1: Identifying New Market Opportunities

1.1 Company Selection: Rotate Lab – Cube Land

- I chose Rotate Lab, specifically its game Cube Land. The game has reached 1M+ downloads and $600K+ in revenue; this indicates that the game is on the rise and that the company is in a growth phase.
- Being based in Türkiye provides an advantage in terms of communication, rapid testing processes, and creative feedback loops. Additionally, as a smaller company, its capabilities on the playable side may be limited, and producing playables quickly may be challenging for them.
- Cube Land's current playable demonstrates the mechanics of shooting at cubes and clearing objects. Playable Factory could help them produce and test different creative variations of this core mechanic more quickly. For example, more curved shots or stronger animations could be used to enhance the sense of clearing and create a more satisfying experience for users.
- Through these different creative variations, the game's IPM (Installs Per Mille) and CVR (Conversion Rate) metrics can be increased; thus, helping reduce Rotate Lab's CPI (Cost Per Install).
- User behavior can be analyzed more effectively within the ad through A/B testing.



Current Creative Reference

1.2 Playable Ad Concept: "Blast & Clean"

Objective: Let users experience Cube Land's cube-blasting and full object-clearing loop in a short time; increase the sense of satisfaction and install intent.

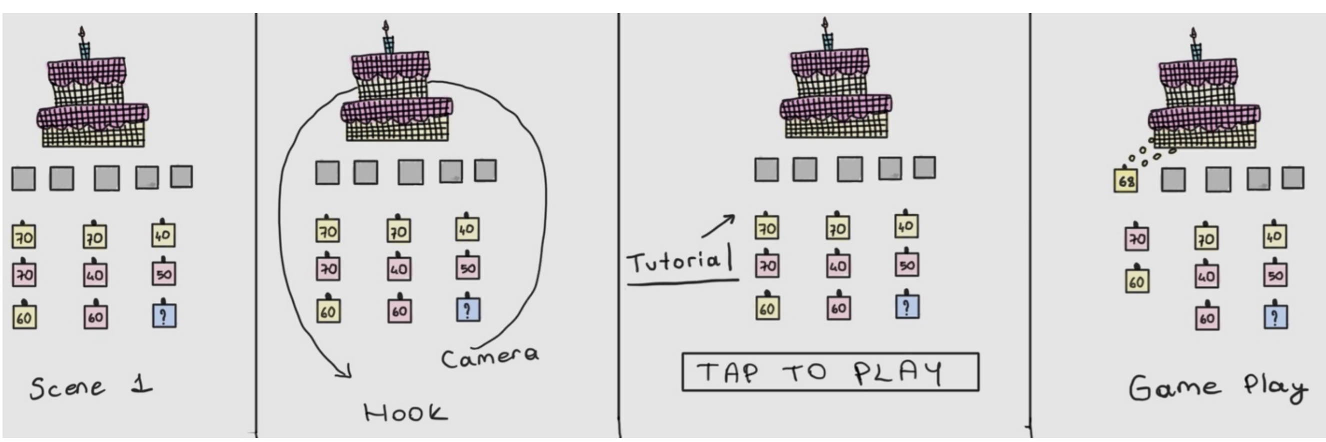
Target Audience: Mobile players aged 13–65 who enjoy casual and block puzzle games and are looking for a relaxing/rewarding gaming experience in short sessions.

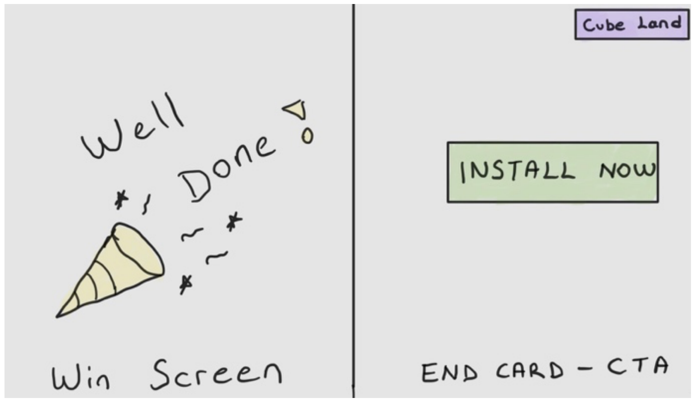
Main Message:
“Send the shooters in the right order, blast the cubes, and clear the object completely!”

Flow:

- **Scene 1 — Initial Setup & Camera Hook (First 3 Seconds):**
  As soon as the playable opens, the camera quickly rotates around the target object (for example, a tower made of cubes) and settles into the ideal shooting angle. This dynamic camera movement serves as a critical “Hook” to capture the user’s attention within the first 3 seconds. The structure to be cleared is in the center, while numbered/colored cubes waiting to be launched are located at the bottom.
- **Scene 2 — Tutorial & Call to Action (Guidance):**
  A prominent “TAP TO PLAY” text appears at the bottom of the screen. The first correct cube the player needs to select (for example, the yellow “70” cube) is highlighted with a glowing effect, and a hand/finger animation appearing on the screen guides the user to tap that cube.
- **Scene 3 — Gameplay & Satisfying Effects:**
  As the player launches the cubes, the matching areas begin to clear. At every clearing moment, visual effects that create the feeling of haptic feedback, light screen shakes, and satisfying particle animations (confetti/sparks) are activated.
- **Scene 4 — Win Screen (Celebration Screen):**
  The area is successfully cleared. Celebration messages such as “Well Done!” appear on the screen alongside a dynamic confetti explosion. The transition should be very fast and rewarding.
- **Scene 5 — End Card (CTA):**
  The screen becomes blurred (blur effect). The Cube Land logo is displayed at the top, while a large pulsing “INSTALL NOW” button is placed in the center.

1.3 Blast & Clean: Playable Ad Flow Wireframe





Hand-drawn Sketch

Ai Generated

Task-2: Proposing Product Improvement

2.1 FLEX: Turn Winning Video Creatives into Interactive Playables in Minutes

Why Flex?
Flex enables teams to turn existing video creatives into interactive playable ads quickly, without building a playable from scratch. It is especially valuable for high-performing video creatives that have already proven their appeal through CTR and CVR results.

The Opportunity: Winning Creative → Auto-Flex
I propose evolving Flex from a manual editing tool into an automated workflow that identifies winning video creatives and turns them into interactive Flex Playables.

How It Works?

1. Video creatives are launched and tested on ad networks.
2. Auto-Flex monitors CTR and CVR performance through ad network APIs.
3. When a creative exceeds the defined performance threshold, AI automatically adds interaction points, tap areas, and guiding hand icons.
4. The playable is generated and pushed back to the ad network within minutes.

Why It Matters?

- **Speed:** Turn a winning video into a playable within minutes instead of waiting days for a coded version.
- **Scalability:** Test hundreds of video variations without creating an engineering bottleneck.
- **Performance:** Complex scenes, such as 10,000-cube physics sequences, can be delivered as video-based playables without lag or device-performance risk.
- **Capture the hype:** If a video creative becomes successful overnight, its playable version can be automatically produced and launched while the team is offline.
- **Efficiency:** Developer resources are focused only on concepts that have already demonstrated strong performance.

Expected Impact
Faster iteration cycles, more playable tests, lower production effort, and a higher chance of converting winning video creatives into scalable UA performance.

Task 3: Evaluating Playable Factory's Playable

3.1 All in Hole – Playable Ad Analysis & Recommendations

The playable turns All in Hole's core "collect and grow" loop into a short and fast-paced experience.

1. At the beginning of the game, the user is presented with two character options. This choice encourages the user to tap and start playing within the first few seconds.
2. The user controls the hole on the screen by dragging it with their finger.
3. When the hole is moved over small objects in the scene, those objects are swallowed/collected.
4. As the hole grows with the collected objects, the player experiences a quick sense of progress and becoming more powerful.
5. The timer, resource icons, and progress indicators in the top interface support the in-game objectives.
6. The red visual effect that appears as the timer runs out reinforces the feeling of completing the level. The countdown creates a sense of urgency and pressure, encouraging players to move faster and pushing them to finish the level before time runs out.
7. After the second scene, the CTA is triggered while the user feels as if they are about to play Level 2.

Strengths of the Current Playable

- The opening message, "Gulp them all!", serves as a strong hook by making the game's core objective immediately understandable. Since the first three seconds are critical in playable ads, this message is valuable for capturing the user's attention.
- Offering two character options at the beginning immediately invites the user to interact.
- The time limit, progress bar, and red effect that appears toward the end of the timer create pace and pressure, helping the player stay focused on the game.
- The hole grows faster in the playable compared to the actual game, allowing the user to collect more objects and creating a more satisfying experience.

Three Most Critical Things I Would Implement or Change

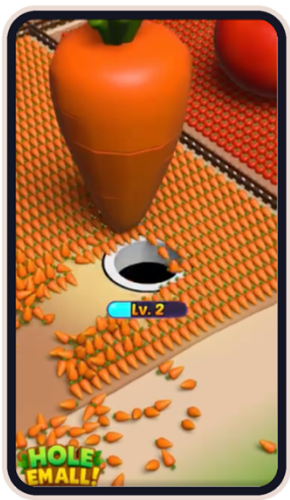
1. **Tutorial & First-Second Engagement**

    - A short tutorial should be added as an early engagement hook, helping players understand the game's objective within the first few seconds. A joystick showing an infinity symbol can be included to guide the player's first move. The first interaction should also feel satisfying, so players immediately understand the core mechanic and remain engaged with the playable.

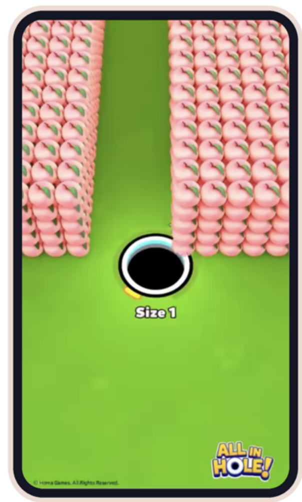
- When selecting one of the two characters, there can be a scale-down or scale-up effect so that the user understands that it is clickable. There should be a tutorial for both character selection and the game.

2. **Progression & Satisfying Feedback**

- Huge stacked structures can be broken into smaller pieces and collected. Based on competitor analysis, the balance of the structure breaks down and hundreds of objects flow smoothly into the hole with a realistic physics animation, like a waterfall.



Competitor analysis:
Hole Em All Creative Proof



Level Indicator from Game Creative Video

- There can be a level indicator underneath the hole or a circle around it to show that the hole will grow and to communicate progress.
- To create a sense of achievement and progression, cards on the progress bar can flip over for objects that the user has completely finished, and fruits can move toward the cards.
- Absorption particles, screen shakes, and similar effects can be added to enhance the feeling.

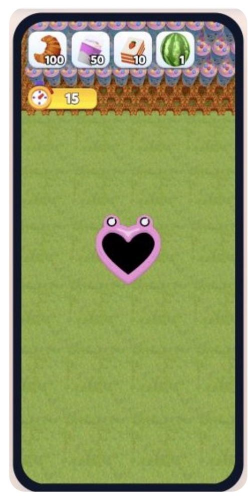
3. CTA & Power-Up Usage

- At the end of the playable, I would reveal the progress bars next to the CTA and place the game icon or “Download Now” in the other corner. If the user does not tap the close button, the CTA is triggered and the user is redirected to the app store.
  Note: A fake close button should not be used; AppLovin or other networks may reject the campaign.
- In case the user is not redirected to the store through the main CTA, a banner should also be used as a secondary conversion path, allowing the user to access the store through the banner.
- By letting the user use power-ups, they can be redirected to the store and CTA when they tap on them. For example, a Super Magnet could be offered to collect all objects at once, creating a strong incentive to download the full game.

Preview evidence

SELECT

DRAG



REDIRECT

Conclusion

Working through this case study allowed me to think end-to-end about how Playable Factory creates value for mobile game studios — from spotting a company that could benefit from playable ads, to designing a playable concept, to proposing product improvements, and finally to critically evaluating an existing playable built with Playable Studio.

Across all three tasks, a few themes kept coming up: the first three seconds of a playable are decisive for engagement, clear tutorials and guided interactions materially improve conversion, and satisfying feedback (animation, physics, particles) is what turns a functional playable into a genuinely persuasive one. I tried to reflect these principles consistently in my proposals.

I really enjoyed putting this together and would love the opportunity to bring this way of thinking to the Product team at Playable Factory.

References

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- https://playablefactory.com/flex
- https://youtu.be/MEioRd2bJvQ?si=nh4DCKUDXMy4sjId
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Thank You.

Thank you to the Playable Factory team for this opportunity and for taking the time to review my work. I really enjoyed exploring your products and thinking creatively about how playable ads can help mobile game studios grow.

I look forward to the possibility of discussing this case study with you.

Best regards,

Ceren Yaşar